

US likely to restrict diesel exports

送信者: EG United States 受信日時: 2026-09-24 05:29

【メール原文】

The US will restrict diesel exports in early October. The administration appears to be moving toward export controls in the coming weeks, faster than |||||

United States

Customize Email Preferences

US likely to restrict diesel exports

23 Sep 2026 16:25 EDT Discover more on the Portal

Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

*

The White House is likely to move forward with partial restrictions on the export of US diesel in early October, several weeks earlier than we previously expected (65% odds).

*

The looming US harvest season is increasing the political pressure on Trump and triggering our changing view; internal opposition from Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Secretary of Energy Chris Wright appears to be outweighed by this pressure, though near-term price decreases would raise our 35% odds that no restrictions are imposed.

*

US restrictions will likely ramp up gradually via BIS export license requirements, driving up global prices due to the US's role as a major exporter, while domestic price impacts are likely to be regionally specific and temporary.

The US will restrict diesel exports in early October. The administration appears to be moving toward export controls in the coming weeks, faster than our initial expectation of late October (see Diesel export controls likely if prices remain elevated , 22 September 2026). We initially expected that diesel exports were likely only if US prices stayed above 2022 highs beyond 15 October. It is now likely that the White House will move forward before 15 October (65% odds). Trump has multiple options to impose restrictions via either emergency authority or executive action and does not need congressional approval.

Agricultural state politics outweigh internal administration opposition to export curbs. Spiking diesel costs during harvest season for major US field crops has created significant backlash among key parts of Trump's base. Export restrictions were first floated in the early spring but were dropped due to concerns from key figures like Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Energy Secretary Chris Wright, as well as the June US-Iran memorandum of understanding which temporarily eased market pressures. With the US likely to continue its strategy of economic pressure and a naval blockade on Iran into late 2026, near-term political pressure from elevated prices outweighs functional concerns, as reflected in comments from both Bessent and Wright in recent days. Both now support—somewhat hesitantly—potential export curbs.

These functional concerns, namely the limited upside on domestic price impact and potential for global supply disruption, remain relevant and would trigger the 35% scenario in which curbs are not imposed. Near-term price reductions to near the 2022 high of \$5.81/gallon would be needed to make this scenario our base case.

Restrictions are likely to be partial and begin gradually. The US is likely to use restrictions to lower exports from their current highs near 1.4 million barrels per day, nearer to pre-war levels of roughly 1 million barrels per day, rather than halt them entirely. This middle ground was first floated in the spring as a potential option, with proponents—some hesitant—seeing it as a way to avoid collapsing US output or triggering global price spikes and supply disruptions. There are several options to implement this approach, though the administration will likely favor using BIS export licenses with a presumption of denial. This option would give the administration the option to begin restrictions on a gradual scale, and then ramp the pressure up or down over time. In theory, this would also allow specific nations to be targeted—a useful messaging tool for the administration—though there is no workable enforcement mechanism once diesel is on the global market.

Price relief in the US would be regional and short-term. Export curbs would lead to fuel surpluses on the Gulf Coast and in the Midwest, where the US has excess refining capacity: Inventories there would rise and retail prices would fall slightly due to the additional supply. The East and West Coasts, which depend on imported fuel to a greater extent, would see little if any relief. Any downward movement in prices would be temporary, as refiners would likely reduce operations as inventories fill up. Any reduction in operations would likely affect diesel and other refined products, including gasoline—reduced supply would, in time, push prices up again until the ban is lifted.

Latin America and Europe face the largest price impacts. The US is the world's largest diesel exporter, accounting for roughly 20% of global seaborne diesel exports. Europe and Latin America are the largest markets for US diesel and would be worst affected, especially as their ability to access alternative sources of supply has been constrained due to disruptions in global flows from the wars in the Middle East and Russia-Ukraine.

There's a risk that a US move prompts the EU to restrict refined product exports. Likely US export curbs come just as European winter heating oil demand increases. Europe has spare refining capacity, so as long as crudes with a high middle distillate yield are available, there should be no outright supply shortages. However, Brussels might respond to the US move by restricting European exports of products to free up more fuel for European households. This would freeze trade of middle distillates in the Atlantic basin and could cause shortages wherever there is insufficient refining capacity. Brussels currently has no such plans, but shortages from US action could force it to intervene to protect EU households.

Clayton Allen

Practice Head, United States

+1 202.903.0027

allen@eurasiagroup.net

Gregory Brew

Senior Analyst, Iran & Energy

+1 646 259 3207
brew@eurasiagroup.net
Henning Gloystein
Managing Director, Energy & Resources
+44 (0)73 898 444 98
gloystein@eurasiagroup.net
EG United States
unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmuejnr2zzgc208n0gftht5eg

[Opt Out](#) | [Customize Email Preferences](#)